

- Critically analyze/evaluate how much time was spent learning syntax & structure, programming concepts vs. actually programming. How does this reflect on the final quality of your end result?

Since I was already familiar with Javascript, not too much time was spent learning syntax and structure. I was initially pretty rusty with the exact syntax for Javascript (I still keep declaring variables with the type), but I've gotten more used to it again. The biggest learning point was how P5.js specifically works. Stuff like matrix transformations with the push() and pop() functions took a little bit of time to get used to. The P5.js docs have been really useful to see exactly how some things work. But when I sat down to work on the project, I was mostly programming, and if I ran into any issues while programming I would consult the docs.

- Comment on your successes and frustrations with Processing and P5.js.

Once again, it was really easy to transition to both of them because of my prior knowledge of Java and Javascript. Programming knowledge in general was also just very helpful. Variable types and scope, functions, loops—I didn't realize how much knowing all that already would help. P5 and Processing also weren't too hard to learn. I had to learn the different functions to make stuff show up on the screen, but it hasn't been too hard to get into.

- What are you struggling with conceptually? What are you struggling with coding-wise? Lastly, what are you struggling with creatively/ideation?

I think some graphical concepts are still a little new to me. Having things move on screen is a little weird, since you have to update the position and redraw it every frame. I've mostly gotten used to it, but figuring out how to make things move nicely/smoothly has been a little more difficult. For Scene 1 with the furry triangle-like things, I wanted it to be interactable and for users to be able to run the mouse through the fur, but I couldn't figure out how to make it work. I'm not sure if it's just really difficult or if I just didn't figure out the right way to do it. Creatively/ideation-wise, I think I'm mostly good. I've been able to come up with ideas—using a lot of techniques from Ideation and Prototyping.

- What measures are you going to take to improve your work in *and* for class? Are these weekly actionable tasks? Tell me a about it. (some examples might include asking questions in class, doing the readings, reviewing the readings, getting a tutor, starting a study group, doing the assigned readings, working your study schedule to allow for both reading and programming, particular time management techniques, etc, etc).

I need to do the readings more. I don't always look at them, and when I do it's usually not too in-depth. I want to look at the Nature of Code book too, and try out the examples in there. Something that helps me is going through a tutorial but being able to pause and try to implement something or changing something myself.

- What could happen during class to help your understanding of the course material? What concepts are you interested in learning more about? What concepts would you like to have reviewed?

I think the in-class challenges are great! Working with someone really helps because you can fill in each others' gaps. I'm very interested in learning about more libraries. I'd also like to get out of just using p5.js if possible. I'm interested in webdev very generally, so I'd like to learn how to make things that fit into a normal website.